CHAPTER 13

CREATING CONTRACTS

In this chapter you'll learn to

- Create a library of standard paragraphs for a contract
- Create a master document for a contract

CREATING A LIBRARY OF STANDARD PARAGRAPHS

In your business documents, you probably use some standard paragraphs over and over. Rather than retyping these paragraphs each time, you can create a library of paragraphs to add to your documents whenever you need them. The following example shows how to create two standard paragraph files for a lease agreement. You can substitute names and text as appropriate for your business.

Create the first standard paragraph file:

1. Open a new document and give it a descriptive name, such as LEASEOP.AGR.

2 Type this text in the file:

```
The leased stage props are available for sale from Stage
Props, Inc., if the lessee decides to keep them after the
lease period.
```

3 Save and close the file.

Now create the second standard paragraph file:

1 Open another document file and name it PROBLEMS.PAR.

2 Type this text in the file:

```
Because of past problems with late return of props, the
lessee agrees to pay a fee of $10.00 per day per prop
after the agreed date if the props are not returned on
time.
```

3 Save and close the file.

TIP If you use many standard paragraphs in your work, you may want to store all the paragraph files in the same directory so they're easy to find.

CREATING A CONTRACT

Now you'll use the standard paragraphs in the master document that you create for the contract. The master document will contain variables instead of actual names. When you print the master document, WordStar asks you what names you want to use in the document and substitutes that information for the variables. You can substitute different information in each contract.

In the steps below, you'll create the master document for a props lease contract. Start by typing the text of the contract.

1 Open a new file and name it LEASE.CTR.

2 Type this text in your document:

```
                    Lease Agreement

This form shall constitute a formal agreement between
&lessee& (the lessee) and Stage Props, Inc. (the lessor).
Under the terms of this agreement, the lessee agrees to
the following conditions:

&lessee& will receive, on loan, the &prop& for a
theatrical performance.

&lessee& agrees to be responsible for the &prop&'s safe
return to Stage Props, Inc., in good condition, with
allowances for normal wear and tear.
```

Notice the ampersands at the beginning and end of each occurrence of "lessee" and "prop." The ampersands tell WordStar that the word is a variable.

Now you'll add clauses to the contract by drawing on your library of standard paragraphs. In the steps below, you'll use conditional commands that tell WordStar to print the text in PROBLEMS.PAR only when a specific condition is met for the lessee. You'll have WordStar ask you at print time whether the lessee has caused problems in the past and to print PROBLEMS.PAR only if you answer "yes."

1 At the end of the LEASE.CTR file, choose Utilities→Merge Print Commands→Ask for Variable (Alt+U,P,A). In the Variable Name box, type **problem**. In the Prompt box, type **Has this account been a problem?** Press F10 or choose OK.

WordStar inserts a **.av** command into the file. When you print the file, WordStar pauses at the **.av** command and asks *Has this account been a problem?* You can answer **Y** (for yes) or **N** (for no).

2 Choose Utilities→Merge Print Commands→If (Alt+U,P,I). In the Variable Name box type **&problem&**. In the Constant box type **Y**. From the Operator (Alphabetical) options, select = same as. Press F10 or choose OK.

The command **.if &problem& = Y** inserted into the lease document tells WordStar to follow the next instruction only if you answered Yes to the *PROBLEM?* prompt.

3 Choose Insert→File at Print Time (Alt+I,L). In the Filename box, type **PROBLEMS.PAR** to insert the problems paragraph. Press F10 or choose OK.

4 Choose Utilities→Merge Print Commands→End If (Alt+U,P,E) to tell WordStar this is the end of the condition.

WordStar inserts the **.ei** command into the file.

Finally, you'll tell WordStar to ask you at print time for the name of the lessee and the type of props being leased.

1 Move your cursor to line 1, column 1 of the document.

2 Choose Utilities→Merge Print Commands→Ask for Variable (Alt+U,P,A). In the Variable Name box, type **lessee**. Press F10 or choose OK.

WordStar inserts the command **.av lessee**. When you print the LEASE.CTR file, WordStar pauses at this command and asks *LESSEE?* You type the name of the lessee.

3 Choose Utilities→Merge Print Commands→Ask for Variable (Alt+U,P,A). In the Variable Name box, type **prop**. Press F10 or choose OK.

WordStar inserts the command **.av prop**. When you print the file, WordStar pauses at this command and asks *PROP?* You type the prop being leased.

Your document should now look like this on the screen:

```
WordStar - C:\WS\LEASE.CTR
File   Edit   View   Insert   Style   Layout   Utilities                Help
Body text              Courier 10 PC    B  I  U  <*>  L  C  R  J  11

.av lessee
.av prop

                    Lease Agreement

This form shall constitute a formal agreement between &lessee&
(the lessee) and Stage Props, Inc. (the lessor).  Under the terms
of this agreement, the lessee agrees to the following conditions:

&lessee& will receive, on loan, the &prop& for a theatrical
performance.

&lessee& agrees to be responsible for the &prop&'s safe return to
Stage Props, Inc., in good condition, with allowances for normal
wear and tear.
.av "Has this account been a problem?",problem
.if &problem&=  Y
.fi problems.par
.ei

                    Insert   P1   L1   V0.50"   C9
```

5 Save and close the file.

Each time you print LEASE.CTR, WordStar asks for the name of the lessee and the prop being leased. The responses are inserted in place of the &lessee& and &props& variables. WordStar then asks about problems. If you answer "yes" to the *PROBLEM?* prompt, WordStar inserts the problems paragraph (PROBLEMS.PAR).

Note: When you print this file, be sure that Interpret Merge Variables is selected in the Print dialog box so WordStar will interpret the merge print commands at print time.